

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK  
COUNTY OF BRONX

-----X  
ROGER SCOTT,

Plaintiff,

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, VICTOR REYES,  
INDIVIDUALLY AND OFFICIALLY IN HIS CAPACITY  
AS NEW YORK CITY POLICE OFFICER, LUIS  
MALDONADO, INDIVIDUALLY AND OFFICIALLY IN  
HIS CAPACITY AS NEW YORK CITY POLICE  
OFFICER, AND JOHN or JANE DOE 1-10,  
INDIVIDUALLY AND OFFICIALLY IN THEIR  
CAPACITIES AS NEW YORK CITY POLICE OFFICERS,

Defendants.  
-----X

Index No.:

Purchased:

Plaintiff designates

Bronx County as the place of trial

The basis of the venue is where the  
injury occurred

**SUMMONS**

**TO THE ABOVE-NAMED DEFENDANTS:**

**YOU ARE HEREBY SUMMONED** to answer the complaint in this action and to serve a copy of your answer, or if the complaint is not served with this summons, to serve a notice of appearance, on the Plaintiff's Attorney(s) within 20 days after the service of this summons, exclusive of the day of service (or within 30 days after the service is complete if this summons is not personally delivered to you within the State of New York); and in case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

Dated: Bayside, New York  
February 27, 2020

  
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**SIM & DEPAOLA, LLP**

By: PETER SIM, Esq.

*Attorneys for Plaintiff*

42-40 Bell Boulevard - Suite 201

Bayside, New York 11361

T: (718) 281-0400

TO: CORPORATION COUNSEL OF THE CITY OF NEW YORK  
100 Church Street  
New York, New York 10007

Detective VICTOR REYES  
Shield # 1897, Tax ID 946510  
At Narcotics Borough of Bronx  
1 Police Plaza Path  
New York, New York 10007

Detective LUIS MALDONADO  
Shield # 1341, Tax ID 950810  
At Narcotics Borough of Bronx  
1 Police Plaza Path  
New York, New York 10007

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK  
COUNTY OF BRONX

-----X  
ROGER SCOTT,

Plaintiff,

Index No.:

Purchased:

-against-

**VERIFIED COMPLAINT**

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, VICTOR REYES,  
INDIVIDUALLY AND OFFICIALLY IN HIS CAPACITY  
AS NEW YORK CITY POLICE OFFICER, LUIS  
MALDONADO, INDIVIDUALLY AND OFFICIALLY IN  
HIS CAPACITY AS NEW YORK CITY POLICE  
OFFICER, AND JOHN or JANE DOE 1-10,  
INDIVIDUALLY AND OFFICIALLY IN THEIR  
CAPACITIES AS NEW YORK CITY POLICE OFFICERS,

Defendants.  
-----X

Plaintiff, SCOTT ROGER by his attorneys, Sim & DePaola, LLP, for his complaint against the above Defendants, City of New York, VICTOR REYES, individually and officially in his capacity as New York City police officer, LUIS MALDONADO, individually and officially in his capacity as New York City police officer, and JOHN or JANE DOE 1-10, individually and officially in their capacities as New York City police officers alleges and states as follows:

1. This is a civil rights action in which Plaintiff seeks relief through 42 U.S.C. §§ 1981, 1983, 1985, 1986 and 1988 for the violations of his civil rights protected by Constitution of the United States and the Constitution and laws of the State of New York.
2. Plaintiff's claims arise from a January 18, 2019 incident, in which Defendants, acting under color of state law, to wit, under color of the statutes, ordinances, regulations, policies, customs and usages of the City and State of New York, unlawfully arrested and detained

Plaintiff. As a direct and proximate results, Plaintiff was unlawfully detained within New York City Police Department, within the jurisdictional confines of Bronx County, New York. Plaintiff was deprived of his liberty for approximately thirty-three (33) hours and suffered serious physical injuries and severe emotional trauma. He was maliciously prosecuted, until received an Adjournment in Contemplation of Dismissal (ACD) from Bronx criminal court.

3. Within 90 days of the claims herein, plaintiff timely serve a notice of claim, upon the City of New York.

4. Over 30 days have elapsed since the filing of this notice, and this matter has not been settled or otherwise disposed of.

5. Plaintiff has complied with municipal defendant's request for an oral examination, pursuant to Section 50-H of the New York General Municipal Law and/or the Public Authorities Law and/or no such request was made within the applicable period.

6. This action and associated claims have been timely commenced within all applicable statutes of limitations.

7. Plaintiff seeks monetary damages (compensatory and punitive) against Defendants, as well as an award of costs and attorneys' fees, and such other and further relief as the Court may deem just and proper.

### **PARTIES**

8. Plaintiff, SCOTT ROGER ("Plaintiff"), resides at 211 Harrison Avenue, County of Bronx and State of New York.

9. Defendant, City of New York ("City"), is a municipal corporation organized under the laws of the State of New York.

10. At all times relevant hereto, Defendant City, acting through the New York City Police Department ("NYPD"), was responsible for the policy, practice, supervision, implementation, and conduct of all NYPD matters and was responsible for the appointment, training, supervision, discipline and retention and conduct of all NYPD personnel, including police officers, detectives and supervisory officers as well as the individually named Defendants herein.

11. At all times here relevant, Defendant City was responsible for enforcing the rules of the NYPD, and for ensuring that the NYPD personnel obey the laws of the United States and of the State of New York.

12. Defendant VICTOR REYES was, at all times here relevant, a police officer or detective employed by the NYPD and as such was acting in the capacity of an agent, servant and employee of the City of New York. Defendant REYES was, at the time relevant herein, a police officer or detective under Shield #1897 and Tax ID 946510 in the NYPD, located at Narcotics Borough of Bronx, 1 Police Plaza Path, New York, New York 10007. Defendant REYES is being sued in his individual and official capacities.

13. Defendant LUIS MALDONADO was, at all times here relevant, a police officer or detective employed by the NYPD and as such was acting in the capacity of an agent, servant and employee of the City of New York. Defendant MALDONADO was, at the time relevant herein, a police officer or detective under Shield #1341 and Tax ID 950810 in the NYPD, located at Narcotics Borough of Bronx, 1 Police Plaza Path, New York, New York 10007. Defendant MALDONADO is being sued in his individual and official capacities.

14. At all times relevant Defendants, including Defendant REYES, Defendant MALDONADO, and John and/or Jane Doe 1-10, were detectives, supervisors, policy makers and/or officials employed by the NYPD. At this time, Plaintiff does not know the true names or

tax registry numbers of Defendants John and/or Jane Doe 1-10, as such knowledge is in the exclusive possession of the Defendants.

15. At all times relevant Defendants John and/or Jane Doe 1-10, were police officers, detectives, supervisors, policy makers and/or officials employed by the NYPD. At this time, Plaintiff does not know the true names or tax registry numbers of Defendants John and/or Jane Doe 1-10, as such knowledge is in the exclusive possession of the Defendants.

16. At all times relevant herein, Defendants, including REYES and MALDONADO, and John and/or Jane Doe 1-10, were acting as agents, servants and employees of the City of New York, and/or the NYPD. Defendants, including REYES and MALDONADO, and John and/or Jane Doe 1-10, are being sued in their individual and official capacities.

17. At all times here mentioned, Defendants, including REYES and MALDONADO, and John and/or John Doe 1-10 were acting under color of state law, to wit, under color of the statutes, ordinances, regulations, policies, customs and usages of the City and State of New York.

### **FACTUAL CHARGES**

18. On January 18, 2019 at approximately 11:00 P.M., Plaintiff was in the vicinity of 708 East 215<sup>th</sup> Street Apt #1A, in the County of Bronx, State of New York.

19. Plaintiff was at the said apartment to meet with his cousin TARIUS GRAY (hereinafter as "Cousin Gray") who was a friend of the residents of the said apartment and thus, a lawful guest to the residents of the said apartment.

20. At all relevant times, Plaintiff was sitting in the living room by the front door at the said apartment to wait for Cousin Gray.

21. At all relevant times, Plaintiff was not involved in any criminal activity inside the said apartment and he was not aware of any criminal activity that occurred within the vicinity of the said apartment.

22. On said date, time and location, Defendants, including REYES, MALDONADO, and John and/or Jane Doe 1-10, illegally broke the door of the said apartment and forcibly entered the premises.

23. On said date, time and location, Defendants, including REYES, MALDONADO, and John and/or Jane Doe 1-10 illegally ordered everyone inside the living room to get down on the ground and maintain that position until there was an order to stand up. Plaintiff complied with the illegal order by immediately getting down on the ground on his stomach.

24. On said date, time and location, Defendants, including REYES, MALDONADO, and John and/or Jane Doe 1-10 illegally seized and searched Plaintiff's person and personal property. Plaintiff was rear-handcuffed while he was on the ground. Defendants forced Plaintiff to stand up by grabbing his arm and lifting him with his arms using excessive force that caused him to suffer significant pain and suffering. Defendants patted down his body, took his personal belongings including his wallet and searched it without his consent. Defendants did not have a valid search warrant or any kind of judicial authority to do so.

25. On said date, time and location, Defendants, including REYES, MALDONADO, and John and/or Jane Doe 1-10 pushed and shoved Plaintiff into a police transport vehicle, and then transferred him back to NYPD 47<sup>th</sup> precinct.

26. Defendants, including REYES, MALDONADO, and John and/or Jane Doe 1-10 then proceeded to criminally process Plaintiff, which included fingerprinting and patting down Plaintiff's entire body.

27. At all relevant times, Defendants, including REYES, MALDONADO, and John and/or Jane Doe 1-10, did not have arrest warrants for Plaintiff.

28. At all relevant times, Defendants, including REYES and MALDONADO, and John and/or Jane Doe 1-10, did not provide full and truthful facts, regarding the likely presence of marijuana, cracked cocaine and paraphernalia to the District Attorney's Office or the Presiding Judge to justify the issuing of a valid search warrant.

29. At all relevant times, Defendants, including REYES and MALDONADO and John and/or Jane Doe 1-10, intentionally provided said false or fabricated information that would be likely to influence a prosecutors employed by the District Attorney's Office to wrongfully prosecute the Plaintiff, namely that Plaintiff was observed to be arrested and searched, so that a criminal prosecution would be initiated against Plaintiff.

30. Defendants, including REYES and MALDONADO, and John and/or Jane Doe 1-10, fabricated the fact that said illicit items were recovered at all or fabricated the locations where said items were recovered, so that they could falsely implicate Plaintiff of various crimes that Defendants knew him to be innocent of.

31. Defendants, including REYES and MALDONADO, and John and/or Jane Doe 1-10, entered said location with the intentions of finding marijuana, cracked cocaine and paraphernalia, on Plaintiff but however, failed to find anything illegal on his person or his reach.

32. Plaintiff was not in actual, constructive, or statutory possession of marijuana, cracked cocaine and paraphernalia; nor did he commit any crime or violation of the law.

33. Plaintiff had multiple assaults and batteries, committed to his person, by Defendants, including REYES and MALDONADO, and John and/or Jane Doe 1-10, including but not



limited to, being placed in handcuffs too tightly, was forced to lay on the ground at his stomach and was grab and shoved by excessive force.

34. Defendants, including REYES and MALDONADO, and John and/or Jane Doe 1-10, falsely claimed they found marijuana, cracked cocaine and paraphernalia on Plaintiff's person, despite being fully aware that no such event or occurrence ever transpired in reality.

35. At no time did Plaintiff possess any marijuana, cracked cocaine or paraphernalia.

36. Defendants', including REYES and MALDONADO, and John and/or Jane Doe 1-10, knowingly and intentionally made false statements and allegations against the Plaintiff and thus, Plaintiff was falsely arrested and charged with possession of marijuana, controlled substance and paraphernalia that Defendants knew to be false since Plaintiff was not in criminal possession of any contraband.

37. Defendants, including REYES and MALDONADO, and John and/or Jane Doe 1-10, were fully aware that Plaintiff did not have any illegal contraband on his person or in his possession because they did not retrieve any contraband from Plaintiff's person, but Defendants, including REYES and MALDONADO, and John and/or Jane Doe 1-10, knowingly and intentionally decided to fabricate said observation to justify an otherwise invalid arrest and to ensure that Plaintiff was maliciously prosecuted.

38. Defendants, including REYES and MALDONADO, and John and/or Jane Doe 1-10, arrested and initiated a criminal prosecution against Plaintiff, not because Defendants believed Plaintiff to be guilty of any crime or violation of the law, but because of their desire to justify an invalid arrest and seizure.

39. Defendants, including REYES and MALDONADO, and John and/or Jane Doe 1-10, ensured Plaintiff's cooperation by fabricating false evidence against Plaintiff, namely that he was observed to be in possession of marijuana.

40. Defendants, including REYES and MALDONADO, and John and/or Jane Doe 1-10, further ensured that Plaintiff would be falsely inculpated by fabricating the locations in which the illicit marijuana, cracked cocaine and paraphernalia was discovered.

41. Plaintiff suffered permanent scars on both his wrists as the direct result of the illegal seizure of his body and handcuffing.

42. Defendant VICTOR REYES was Plaintiff's arresting officer and signed his criminal court complaint under Criminal Docket #2019BX001699, knowingly and falsely accusing Plaintiff of Criminal Possession of Controlled Substance in the third Degree, Criminal Possession of a Controlled Substance in the seventh degree, Criminally Using Drug Paraphernalia in the second degree, Unlawful Possession of Marijuana, all of which Defendants, including REYES and MALDONADO, and John and/or Jane Doe 1-10 knew to be untrue.

43. Plaintiff was arraigned and formally charged with one (1) count of Criminal Possession of a Controlled Substance in the third degree, one (1) count of Criminal Possession of a Controlled Substance in the seventh degree, two (2) counts of Criminally Using Drug Paraphernalia, and one (1) count of Unlawful possession of Marijuana.

44. At no point did the Defendants, including REYES and MALDONADO, and John and/or Jane Doe 1-10, ever observe Plaintiff possessed marijuana, cracked cocaine or paraphernalia.

45. At no point were the Defendants, including REYES and MALDONADO, and John and/or Jane Doe 1-10, ever informed by any witnesses that Plaintiff committed any crime or violation of the law.

46. After his arraignment, Plaintiff was transferred to New York City Police Department, where he was unlawfully detained until his eventual release on, or about, January 20, 2019, to which he lost his freedom and liberty for about thirty-three (33) hours.

47. Plaintiff was compelled to return to court, multiple times, to contest the false charges levied against him, including Criminal Possession of a Controlled Substance in the third and seventh degree, Criminally Using Drug Paraphernalia and Unlawful Possession of Marijuana.

48. Plaintiff received ACD, representing a termination of the criminal charges in Plaintiff's favor.

49. Defendants, including REYES and MALDONADO, and John or Jane Doe 1-10, never possessed probable cause to believe a prosecution would succeed against Plaintiff, or that Plaintiff was guilty of any crime, as Defendants REYES and MALDONADO were fully aware that any evidence against Plaintiff was either fraudulent or fabricated.

50. While Plaintiff was unlawfully detained, Defendants, including REYES and MALDONADO, and John and/or Jane Doe 1-10, acting with malice, conveyed the aforementioned false, misleading and incomplete information to prosecutors in order to have Plaintiff prosecuted for Criminal Possession of a Controlled Substance in the third and seventh degree, Criminally Using Drug Paraphernalia and Unlawful Possession of Marijuana.

51. Defendants, including REYES and MALDONADO, and John and/or Jane Doe 1-10, arrested and attempted cause a criminal prosecution to be initiated against Plaintiff, because of their desires to use Plaintiff's arrest and criminal prosecution as leverage against their true target, to incur additional overtime compensation, benefits and curry favor from their superior officers, to avoid adverse consequences associated with failing to meet NYPD departmental arrest quotas

and also to conceal their egregious violations of proper police procedures and gross misconduct, including their fabrications of non-existent observations, evidence and information.

52. At all times relevant hereto, Defendants, including REYES and MALDONADO, and John and/or Jane Doe 1-10, were involved in the decision to arrest Plaintiff without probable cause or failed to intervene when they observed others arresting Plaintiff without probable cause or using excessive force to effectuate his arrest.

53. At all times relevant hereto, Defendants, including REYES and MALDONADO, and John and/or Jane Doe 1-10, engaged in fraud, perjury, the suppression of evidence and other actions conducted in bad faith, or failed to intervene when Defendants REYES and MALDONADO observed others doing so, all in furtherance of Plaintiff's wrongful arrest and subsequent malicious criminal prosecution.

54. Plaintiff asserts that the Defendants, including REYES and MALDONADO, and John and/or Jane Doe 1-10, who violated Plaintiff's civil rights, are part of a larger pattern and practice of similar misconduct, which is so widespread, pervasive and consistent throughout the NYPD, and the City of New York that the commission such constitutionally violative behavior has become tantamount to an official policy or custom within the NYPD, and City of New York or, at the very least, conclusive evidence that the City, NYPD have either tacitly approved of such egregious wrongdoings or that they have become deliberately indifferent to the civil rights of those who may come into contact their police officers.

55. The individually named Defendants herein, as well as other officers serving in the employment of the NYPD, and City of New York, have blatantly, shamelessly, consistently and repeatedly engaged in conduct violative of the civil rights guaranteed and protected by Constitution of the United States, in addition to the laws and Constitution of the State of New

York, all without incurring any ramifications for such misconduct and, ostensibly, with the full and complete blessing of the NYPD, the City of New York and their respective policymakers and supervisors.

56. In a report by *NBC Channel 4 News, New York*, entitled “Ex NYPD Sergeant Accused of Assaulting Man at Homeless Shelter, Stomping on His Head More Than 10 Times,” by Jonathan Dienst and Joe Valiquette, horrific allegations against a former NYPD police sergeant were detailed, including his use of extreme and excessive force, as well as his falsifying evidence that was forwarded to prosecutors. The former NYPD sergeant is no longer by NYPD and his criminal case is presently being prosecuted by the United States Attorney’s Office for the Southern District of New York. Another article from *citylimits.org*, entitled “CityViews: Is NYPD Oversight Really making Homeless Shelters Safer,” by Daniel Castillo, discusses how the NYPD police officers have begun to jointly enforce the law within many homeless shelters, but how such added policing has only worsened the already crime riddled areas. It also details how ongoing problems have only deteriorated since the newly enacted joint jurisdiction.

57. *The New York Times*, as well as numerous other reputable journalistic enterprises, have reported on the widespread corruption within the NYPD, and City of New York, particularly the incredibly disconcerting proclivity of many NYPD officers to engage in the fabrication or misrepresentation or subject matters that are materially relevant to criminal prosecutions, including the complete fabrication of arrest evidence and witnesses. Also detailed, is the NYPD’s obstinate refusal to effectuate corrective or preventive measures to combat the inevitable recurrence of such misdeeds, and perhaps most troubling, the NYPD’s alarming tendency to, instead, reward and promote these officers, including those who were inculcated via some incontrovertible form of evidence.

58. On March 18, 2018, *The New York Times* published an explosive article, entitled “Promotions, Not Punishments for Officers Accused of Lying,” written by Joseph Goldstein. Mr. Goldstein shines a light on the multitude of flaws within the CCRB and the NYPD, highlighting the fact that the substantiation of a claim against an officer will invariably rely on the presence of incontrovertible proof against the officer. Due to the rarity availability of this type of evidence, an alarmingly small percentage of officer misconduct claims are substantiated. The CCRB is further handicapped by a terribly designed system that requires evidence of a virtually indisputable nature to substantiate any claim against an officer. The article also details the NYPD’s persistent reluctance to investigate or discipline officers who lie and even posits that this reluctance is a significant cause of the lying pandemic within the NYPD. The article references various officers and detectives who were the subject of credible accusations relating to the officers’ intentionally false statements, with some allegations coming from federal and state judges.

59. On September 12, 2019, *The New York Times* published another article by Joseph Goldstein, entitled “Officers Said They Smelled Pot. The Judge Called Them Liars.” Unsurprisingly, this article dealt with the unusually high frequency of officers using the odor of marijuana, cracked cocaine and paraphernalia to excuse a search that conspicuously does not result in the recovery of any marijuana, cracked cocaine and paraphernalia. It should not require an article in *The New York Times* to call attention to such patently disingenuous tactics, but has become necessary for a variety of reasons, including the NYPD’s failure to correct such behavior, the willingness of prosecutors and judges to credit the lying officers and the increasing rate of occurrence.

60. On April 24, 2019, *The New York Times* published an article, entitled “Detective’s Lies Sent Three People to Prison, Prosecutors Charge,” by Sean Piccolo, detailing the lies of NYPD Second Grade Detective Joseph Franco and how those lies resulted in the imprisonment of at least three innocent people. The article described how Det. Franco lied about observing drug transactions on at least three separate occasions, lies that were only uncovered through contradictory video evidence. Det. Franco’s lies resulted in the innocent individuals each being sentenced to prison terms in excess of one-year.

61. Other articles include: (i) “Testilying’ by Police: A Stubborn Problem.,” by Joseph Goldstein, *The New York Times*, March 18, 2018; (ii) “New York Detective Charged with Faking Lineup Results,” by Joseph Goldstein, *The New York Times*, February 17, 2018; (iii) “He Excelled as a Detective, Until Prosecutors Stopped Believing Him,” by Joseph Goldstein, *The New York Times*, October 17, 2017; (iv) “Review Board Notes Rise in New York Police Officers’ False Statement,” by J. David Goodman, *The New York Times*, May 14, 2015; (v) “In Brooklyn Gun Cases, Suspicion Turns to the Police,” by Stephanie Clifford, *The New York Times*, December 11, 2014; (vi) “Detective is Found Guilty of Planting Drugs,” by Tim Stelloh, *The New York Times*, November 1, 2011; and (vii) “The Drugs? They Came From the Police,” by Jim Dwyer, *The New York Times*, October 13, 2011.

62. The NYPD has a longstanding and ignominious record of failing to discipline its officers, or even entertaining allegations of wrongdoing against them. On June 26, 2019, *The New York Times* published an article, entitled “2,495 Reports of Police Bias. Not One Was Deemed Valid by the N.Y.P.D.” This article reported that within the last five (5) years, almost 2,500 separate individuals have filed formal complaints with the NYPD alleging that an officer acted with bias toward them, with not a single one being substantiated by the NYPD. Such a finding is plainly

incredible and obviously the result of deliberately poor or nonexistent investigatory protocols.

The report further impugned the NYPD's commitment to combat the prejudices and the biases exhibited by many of its officers.

63. Upon information and belief, the NYPD, the City of New York, and their respective policymakers, officials or supervisors have imposed, tacitly approved or acquiesced to policies, customs, or patterns and practices within the NYPD that resulted in plaintiff's arrest without probable cause.

64. Upon information and belief, the NYPD, the City of New York, and their respective policymakers or supervisors have failed to provide adequate training regarding the identification of probable cause, reasonable suspicion or the appropriate amount of force to be used.

65. Defendants' actions, pursuant to Plaintiff's underlying arrest, which occurred without even the semblance of probable cause, were so blatantly violative of Plaintiff's civil rights that the tacit approval of identical or similar acts by the policymakers or supervisors of the NYPD, and the City of New York, as well as their deliberate indifference towards the rights of any individuals who may come into contact with Defendants, should be inferred, because such flagrant deprivations of constitutionally protected rights could not and would not occur without the tacit approval or deliberate indifference regarding the commission of such violations by the policymakers or supervisors of the NYPD, and City of New York.

66. Upon information and belief, further details and facts, relating to the unlawful policies, customs or patterns and practices of the NYPD, City of New York and their respective policymakers, supervisors, police officers or employees, will become known after the completion of discovery, as such information is presently within the exclusive possession of Defendants, the NYPD, and City of New York.



67. Upon information and belief, the personnel files, records and disciplinary histories of the officer Defendants will reveal a history of Constitutional violations indicative of Defendant City's knowledge that the individual officer Defendants were unfit for employment as NYPD officers, or for employment in general, and that the probability of the individually named Defendants committing similar violations in the future was extremely high.

68. Upon information and belief, said personnel files, records and disciplinary histories will conclusively show that the City, and the NYPD were fully aware of Defendants' past constitutional violations, the unacceptably high probability for the recurrence of similar transgressions, the unreasonably dangerous situations that were likely to result from their hiring or retention, as well as their unsuitability for employment as law enforcement officers, or for employment in general, and that the NYPD, and City of New York failed to engage in any preventive or corrective action intended to diminish the likelihood of recurrence for such violations, which is tantamount to the City's tacit approval of such misconduct or the City's deliberate indifference towards the civil rights of those who may interact with its employees, including Blair, John or Jane Doe 1-10.

69. As a direct and proximate result of the acts of Defendants, including the City, whose including Blair, John or Jane Doe 1-10, Plaintiff suffered the following injuries and damages: violations of his rights pursuant to the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendment of the United States Constitution, violations of New York State law, physical injury, physical pain and suffering, emotional trauma and suffering, including fear, embarrassment, humiliation, emotional distress, frustration, extreme inconvenience, anxiety, loss of liberty and harm to reputation.

**FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION**

Unlawful Search and Seizure Under  
New York State Law

70. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.

71. Defendants subjected plaintiff and his property to unreasonable searches and seizures without a valid warrant and without reasonable suspicion or probable cause do so.

72. Plaintiff was conscious and fully aware of the unreasonable searches and seizures to his person and property.

73. Plaintiff did not consent to the unreasonable searches and seizures to his person or property.

74. The unreasonable searches and seizures to plaintiff's person and property were not otherwise privileged.

75. Accordingly, defendants violated plaintiff's right to be free from unreasonable searches and seizures, pursuant to the Fourth Amendment to the United States Constitution and Article I, Section 12, of the New York State Constitution.

76. Defendant City of New York, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoings under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

77. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

**SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION**  
Unlawful Search and Seizure Under  
42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

78. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.

79. Defendants subjected plaintiff and his property to unreasonable searches and seizures without a valid warrant and without reasonable suspicion or probable cause do so.

80. Plaintiff was conscious and fully aware of the unreasonable searches and seizures to his person and property.

81. Plaintiff did not consent to the unreasonable searches and seizures to his person or property.

82. The unreasonable searches and seizures to plaintiff's person and property were not otherwise privileged.

83. Accordingly, defendants violated plaintiff's right to be free from unreasonable searches and seizures, pursuant to the Fourth Amendment to the United States Constitution and Article I, Section 12, of the New York State Constitution.

84. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

### **THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION**

False Arrest and False Imprisonment Under  
New York State Law

85. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.

86. Defendants subjected Plaintiff to false arrest, false imprisonment, and deprivation of liberty without probable cause.

87. Plaintiff was conscious of his confinement.

88. Plaintiff did not consent to his confinement.

89. Plaintiff's arrest and false imprisonment was not otherwise privileged.

90. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

91. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

### **FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION**

False Arrest and False Imprisonment Under  
42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

92. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.

93. The Defendants violated the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the U.S. Constitution by wrongfully and illegally arresting, detaining and imprisoning Plaintiff.

94. The wrongful, unjustifiable, and unlawful apprehension, arrest, detention, and imprisonment of Plaintiff was carried out without a valid warrant, without Plaintiff's consent, and without probable cause or reasonable suspicion.

95. At all relevant times, Defendants acted forcibly in apprehending, arresting, and imprisoning Plaintiff.

96. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

#### **FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION**

Assault and Battery Under  
New York State Law

97. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.

98. Defendants made plaintiff fear for his physical well-being and safety and placed him in apprehension of immediate harmful or offensive touching.

99. Defendants engaged in and subjected plaintiff to immediate harmful or offensive touching and battered him without his consent.

100. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

101. As a direct and proximate result of this breach, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

#### **SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION**

Excessive Force Under  
42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

102. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.

103. The Defendants violated Plaintiff's rights under the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments, because they used unreasonable force without Plaintiff's consent.

104. Defendants engaged in and subjected Plaintiff to immediate harmful and/or offensive touching and battered him without his consent.

105. As a direct and proximate result of this breach, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

**SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION**

Denial of Right to Fair Trial Under  
New York State Law

106. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

107. Defendants fabricated false evidence to be used against plaintiff that was likely to influence a jury's decision.

108. Defendants forwarded said false information to the District Attorney's Office.

109. Defendants' actions resulted in post-arraignment deprivation to plaintiff's liberty and freedom of movement.

110. Accordingly, defendants violated plaintiff's right to a fair trial, pursuant to Article I, Sections 1, 2 and 6 of the New York State Constitution, as well Article II, Section 12, of the New York State Civil Rights Law.

111. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

112. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

**EIGHTH CAUSE OF ACTION**

Denial of Right to Fair Trial Under  
42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

113. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.

114. Defendants fabricated false evidence to be used against plaintiff that was likely to influence a jury's decision.

115. Defendants forwarded said false information to the District Attorney's Office.

116. Defendants' actions resulted in post-arraignment deprivation to plaintiff's liberty and freedom of movement.

117. Accordingly, defendants violated Plaintiff's right to a fair trial, pursuant to the Sixth and Fourteenth Amendments to United States Constitution

118. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

**NINETH CAUSE OF ACTION**

Deprivation of Rights and Denial of Equal Protection of the Laws under  
New York State law

119. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

120. Plaintiff, as a Hispanic male, is a member of a racial minority and protected class.

121. Defendants discriminated against Plaintiff on the basis of his race, color or ethnicity.

122. Defendants also engaged in the selective of Plaintiff, in comparison to others similarly situated.

123. Defendants' selective treatment of Plaintiff was based on impermissible considerations, such as race, color, ethnicity, an intent to inhibit or punish Plaintiff's exertion of his Constitutional rights, or a malicious or bad faith intent to injure Plaintiff.

124. Defendants applied facially neutral laws against Plaintiff in a discriminatory manner.

125. Defendants, motivated by discriminatory animus, applied facially neutral statutes with adverse effects against Plaintiff.

126. Defendants did not possess a rational basis, excuse or justification for applying any laws or statutes against Plaintiff.

127. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

128. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

#### **TENTH CAUSE OF ACTION**

Deprivation of Rights and Denial of Equal Protection of the Laws under  
42 U.S.C. §§ 1981 and 1983 Against Individual Defendants

129. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

130. Plaintiff, as a Hispanic male, is a member of a racial minority and protected class.

131. Defendants discriminated against Plaintiff on the basis of his race, color or ethnicity

132. Defendants also selectively treated Plaintiff in comparison to others similarly situated.

133. Defendants' selective treatment of Plaintiff was based on impermissible considerations, such as race, color, ethnicity, an intent to inhibit or punish Plaintiff's exertion of his Constitutional rights, or malicious or bad faith intent to injure Plaintiff.

134. Defendants applied facially neutral laws against Plaintiff in a discriminatory manner.

135. Defendants, motivated by a discriminatory animus, applied facially neutral penal statutes with adverse effects against Plaintiff.

136. Defendants did not possess a rational basis, excuse or justification for applying any laws or statutes against Plaintiff.

137. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

**ELEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION**

Conspiracy to Interfere with Civil Rights and Failure to Prevent the Conspiracy under  
42 U.S.C. §§ 1981, 1983, 1985 and 1986 Against Individual Defendants

138. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

139. Defendants engaged in a conspiracy against Plaintiff to deprive Plaintiff of the equal protection of the laws, or of the privileges and immunities under the laws.

140. Defendants committed overt acts in furtherance of their conspiracy against Plaintiff.

141. Plaintiff sustained injuries to his person or was deprived of rights or privileges of citizens of the United States.

142. Defendants' conspiracy was motivated by some racial, or otherwise class-based, invidious discriminatory animus.

143. The Defendants that did not engage or participate in the conspiracy to interfere with Plaintiff's civil rights, had knowledge that acts in furtherance of the conspiracy were about to be committed or being committed, possessed the power to prevent or aid, and neglected to do so.

144. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

**TWELVETH CAUSE OF ACTION**

Failure to Intervene Under  
New York State Law

145. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

146. Those Defendants that were present but did not actively participate in the aforementioned unlawful conduct, observed such conduct, had an opportunity to prevent such conduct, had a duty to intervene and prevent such conduct, and failed to intervene.



147. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

148. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

**THREETEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION**

Failure to Intervene Under  
42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

149. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

150. Those Defendants that were present but did not actively participate in the aforementioned unlawful conduct observed such conduct, had an opportunity to prevent such conduct, had a duty to intervene and prevent such conduct, and failed to intervene.

151. Accordingly, the Defendants who failed to intervene violated the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments.

152. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

**FOURTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION**

Negligent Hiring, Training, Retention and Supervision Under  
New York State Law

153. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.

154. Defendant City owed a duty of care to Plaintiff to adequately hire, train, retain and supervise its employee defendants.

155. Defendant City breached those duties of care.

156. Defendant City placed defendants in a position where they could inflict foreseeable harm.

157. Defendant City knew or should have known of its employee defendants' propensity for violating the individual rights granted under the United States Constitution and the laws of the State of New York, prior to the injuries incurred by Plaintiff.

158. Defendant City failed to take reasonable measures in hiring, training, retaining and supervising its employee defendants that would have prevented the aforesaid injuries to Plaintiff.

159. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

**FIFTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION**

Municipal "*Monell*" Liability Under  
42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Defendant City

160. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.

161. Defendant City maintained a policy or custom that caused Plaintiff to be deprived of his civil rights, tacitly approved of such violative conduct or was deliberately indifferent toward the potential exposure of individuals, such as plaintiff, to such violative behavior.

162. Defendant City's employee police officers have engaged in an illegal pattern and practice of misconduct, so consistent and widespread that it constitutes a custom or usage, of which a supervisor or policymaker must have been aware of.

163. Defendant City and its policymakers failed to provide adequate training or supervision to their subordinates to such an extent that is tantamount to a deliberate indifference toward the rights of those who may come into contact with defendant City's employees.

164. Defendant City's employees engaged in such egregious and flagrant violations of plaintiff's Constitutional rights that the need for enhanced training or supervision is obvious and equates to a display of deliberate indifference by defendant City and its policymakers toward the rights of individuals, who may come into contact with defendant City's employees.

165. Defendant City's repeated refusal or failure to install or apply corrective or preventive measures constitutes the tacit approval of such violative behavior or a deliberate indifference to the rights of those who may be affected by such behavior.

166. Defendant City's conduct caused the violation of plaintiff's civil rights, pursuant to Constitution of the United States.

167. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

**WHEREFORE**, Plaintiff respectfully requests judgment against Defendants, jointly and severally, as follows:

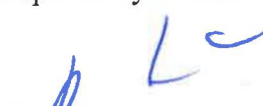
- a) In favor of Plaintiff in an amount to be determined by a jury for each of Plaintiff's causes of action;
- b) Awarding Plaintiff punitive damages in an amount to be determined by a jury;
- c) Awarding Plaintiff compensatory damages in an amount to be determined by a jury;
- d) Awarding Plaintiff reasonable attorneys' fees and costs pursuant to 42 U.S.C. § 1988; and
- e) Granting such other and further relief as this Court deems just and proper.

**JURY DEMAND**

Plaintiff demands a trial by jury.

Dated: February 27, 2020

Respectfully submitted,

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PETER SIM, Esq.  
Sim & DePaola, LLP  
*Attorneys for Plaintiff*  
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## ATTORNEY VERIFICATION

I, PETER SIM, an attorney admitted to practice in the courts of New York State, state that I am an partner with the firm of **SIM & DEPAOLA, LLP**, the attorneys of record for Plaintiff in the within action; I have read the foregoing and know the contents thereof; the same is true to my own knowledge, except as to the matters therein stated to be alleged on information and belief, and as to those matters I believe it to be true. The reason this verification is made by me and not by Plaintiff, is because Plaintiff reside outside the county where deponent maintains his office. I affirm that the foregoing statements are true, under the penalties of perjury.

Dated: Bayside, New York  
February 27, 2020

  
\_\_\_\_\_  
PETER SIM, ESQ.

Index No.:

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK  
COUNTY OF BRONX

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ROGER SCOTT,

Plaintiff,

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, VICTOR REYES, INDIVIDUALLY AND OFFICIALLY IN HIS  
CAPACITY AS NEW YORK CITY POLICE OFFICER, LUIS MALDONADO,  
INDIVIDUALLY AND OFFICIALLY IN HIS CAPACITY AS NEW YORK CITY POLICE  
OFFICER, AND JOHN or JANE DOE 1-10, INDIVIDUALLY AND OFFICIALLY IN THEIR  
CAPACITIES AS NEW YORK CITY POLICE OFFICERS,

Defendants.

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**SUMMONS AND VERIFIED COMPLAINT**

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**SIM & DEPAOLA, LLP**  
BY: PETER SIM, ESQ.  
Attorney for Plaintiff  
42-40 Bell Boulevard, Ste. 201  
Bayside, NY 11361  
Tel. (718) 281-0400

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To: CORPORATION COUNSEL OF THE CITY OF NEW YORK

Attorney(s) for Defendants

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Service of a copy of the within is hereby admitted.  
Dated

Attorney(s) for